protected area of Lahore International Airport was the direct result of the government of Pakistan having permitted their territory to be used for instigating, abetting and encouraging unlawful and subversive activities against India.

What was more shocking was that an Indian intelligence warning in September 1970 about the existence of a conspiracy in Pakistan to hijack Indian aircraft had not been heeded. India and the USA were also peeved over the fact that the hijackers were given asylum and the ISI had publicly expressed their solidarity with the hijackers.

'The two criminals were allowed to destroy the aircraft in full view of the troops, police and other airport personnel. Pakistan permitted the two hijackers to move and act freely in the airport area and terminal building, including making long-distance calls to their accomplices in Pakistan and meeting political leaders like Zulfikar Ali Bhutto and Mahmood Ali Ka-suri and others freely,' India had charged. India banned Pakistani flights over Indian territory and this move caused a little unrest in the US establishment, which wanted India to resolve the issue as per International Civil Aviation Organization (ICAO) norms. What was more intriguing was the fact that Pakistan's commission of inquiry constituted by President Yahya Khan blamed Indian intelligence in April 1971. The Indian government countered:

Casting the hijackers into the role of some Indian 007, however flattering to Indian intelligence, is so grotesque that we cannot take the inquiry seriously. Commission says that the hijackers were armed with only dummy weapons. This totally repudiates the Pakistan foreign secretary's version that the hijackers exhibited hand grenades to prevent the Pakistani authorities at